Manual Age Review

Briefing for legal counsel: Vib3Pulse

Prepared	25 October 2026
Product	Vib3Pulse, a nightlife and social app serving London and Lagos, with live audio and video rooms
Controller	Aeolus Labs Ltd (name and registration to be confirmed by the company)
Contact for data requests	info@aeoluslabsltd.com
Status	Feature designed and in development. Not live. It stays switched off until counsel has reviewed this document.
Nature of this document	A factual briefing prepared by the product team from the design specification and a review of the codebase. It is not legal advice and states no legal conclusions. Where the facts could not be established from the code they are marked UNKNOWN.

What we are asking counsel to do

1. Confirm the lawful basis and consent design for the age review (Section 6), including whether a consent obtained in exchange for access to adult features is valid.
2. Say whether the processing is high risk and needs a data protection impact assessment, and what registrations or filings apply in Nigeria and the United Kingdom.
3. Review the privacy pop-up wording (Appendix A) and the public privacy policy page we are publishing.
4. Advise on children's data: our minimum age is 13 and there is no parental consent step (Section 7).
5. Advise on retention, deletion and the data subject rights process, including gaps in the existing platform that we list candidly in Section 10.
6. Answer the numbered questions in Section 11.

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1 Why we are doing this

Vib3Pulse lets adults tip performers and hosts in live rooms, buy tickets to events, and host paid rooms. Those features must only be used by adults. Users give a date of birth when they register, but that date is self-declared and nothing else corroborates it. Today the only way an account can be marked as verified is for an administrator to set it by hand with no evidence required.

We want to give users a way to prove they are 18 or over that does not force them to hand a government ID to a social platform. We therefore propose two routes, chosen by the user: uploading an ID photo with a selfie, or a private live video check with a trained reviewer in which nothing is recorded or stored.

Features that will require a verified adult: tipping (called spraying), buying tickets to paid rooms, hosting paid rooms, and receiving tips or payouts. Everything else in the app remains available without verification.

The registered date of birth is treated as the claim. The review must corroborate it. If the evidence shows a different date the account is corrected under a defined rule (Section 2).

2 The proposed process

User journey

1. The user opens Account settings and chooses Verify your age, or is sent there when a feature is blocked.
2. A privacy pop-up appears before anything is captured. The user must tick a box to continue. The consent version and time are recorded. Appendix A has the full text.
3. Upload route: the user chooses a document type (passport, driver's licence, national ID card or NIN slip), photographs it (they may cover everything except their photo, name and date of birth), then takes a selfie holding a one-time code shown on screen. The code lasts 30 minutes. The browser re-encodes the images, which removes embedded location data.
4. Live route: the user asks for a live check. A reviewer sends an invite valid for 15 minutes. Both join a private two-person video room. No recording is made. The user shows the document to the camera.
5. A reviewer decides. The user is told the result by in-app notification and email.

Decisions available to a reviewer

Outcome	When	Effect
Verify	Document birthdate matches the registered birthdate and the person is 18 or over	Account marked verified. Evidence deleted at once.
Teen correction	Document shows under 18 but the account was registered as an adult	Account is moved to the teen age group immediately by one reviewer, adult-only memberships end and money features turn off. Evidence deleted.
Birthdate change	Document shows a different adult birthdate	Held for a second approval by a different super-administrator. Only then is the birthdate corrected and the account verified.
Needs more	Photo unclear	User asked for another photo, at most twice.
Decline	Unreadable, expired, face mismatch, code missing, looks edited, other	No change. User may retry within limits (3 declines per 30 days, 24 hours apart).
Not eligible (minor)	Document matches the registered birthdate and shows under 18	No change. Request closed.

A reviewer must tick a checklist before Verify is enabled: the face matches the selfie, the code on the selfie matches, the document type matches the one chosen, the document is not expired, the birthdate is readable, and there are no signs of editing. A reviewer cannot decide their own request.

3 Who can see what

Role	Age review access
Ordinary user	Their own request status only. They can never read evidence back, including their own.
age_reviewer (new role)	Review queue, evidence reveal, decisions, live checks. Granted only by a super-administrator.
admin	Same as age_reviewer.
super_admin	Everything above, plus second approval of birthdate changes, the emergency purge, pausing intake and resuming it, and granting roles.
user_support, content_moderator, event_reviewer, finance_manager, analytics_viewer	No access to evidence. The old direct 'mark verified' action is removed from user_support.

Two administrator accounts exist today, both super_admin. No staff hold the other roles yet.

Controls on viewing evidence: images are not sent until the reviewer clicks Reveal; the reveal returns a single-use token valid for 60 seconds; the image carries the reviewer's name and the request id as an on-screen overlay and re-blurs after 30 seconds; every reveal is written to the admin audit log; reveals are limited to 60 per reviewer per hour; the response is sent with headers that prevent caching and storage.

Live call: the room admits only the user and the reviewer, closes after 20 minutes, and no recording or egress is configured. The user sees a persistent 'Not recorded' notice.

Staff two-factor login: today super-administrators are required to use two-factor login only when an environment setting is switched on (production value UNKNOWN). When the age review feature is switched on, the code requires two-factor login for the admin and age_reviewer roles. Super-administrators are NOT forced onto two-factor by this feature: the owner has chosen to leave them on the existing setting (required only if the environment setting is switched on). Super-administrators can open evidence, so for them the protections are the single-use 60 second reveal link, the hourly reveal limit, the audit log and the on-screen watermark, with no second factor. Counsel is asked whether that is adequate (Question 8).

Reviewers cannot see drafts: a user's photos are not visible to any reviewer until the user sends the request. A reviewer cannot open evidence of their own account.

4 Personal data involved in the age review

Data	Source	Purpose	Stored how, for how long
Photo of an identity document (passport, driver's licence, national ID or NIN slip)	User upload	Compare the document's birthdate and photo with the registered birthdate and the selfie	Encrypted (AES-256-GCM, bound to the request) in a dedicated table. Deleted when a decision is made, on cancel, or after 7 days if unreviewed.
Selfie holding a one-time code	User upload	Check that the person submitting is the person on the document	Same as above.
Registered date of birth snapshot	Provided at sign-up	Compare with the document	Kept on the request record (see retention).
Document type	User choice	Guide the review	Kept on the request record.
One-time selfie code	Generated by the system	Lets the reviewer check the selfie was taken now	Kept readable on the request until the final decision, then removed.
Proposed birthdate from the ID (only when it differs)	Reviewer typed from the document	Held for the second approver	Kept on the request until the final decision, then removed. Not visible to anyone except the second approver.
Reviewer's free-text note (up to 300 characters)	Reviewer	Explain a decision	Written to the append-only admin audit log. Reviewers are told not to write personal details in it.

Data	Source	Purpose	Stored how, for how long
Keyed hash of the document number (fingerprint)	Typed by the reviewer, never stored in clear	Stop one document verifying many accounts	Only the hash is kept. It cannot be reversed without the secret key. Retention to be decided with counsel (Question 6).
Reviewer identity, times, outcome, whether the birthdate matched, decline reason	System	Audit and dispute handling	Kept on the request record. No images, names or document numbers (only the one-way fingerprint above).
Consent version and time	System	Proof of consent	Kept on the request record.
Live video and audio	User and reviewer devices	Real-time document check	Not recorded and not stored. Passes through the video service provider while the call lasts.
Verification result	System	Unlock adult features	Flag on the user account: verified, method, date.

We do not create or store a face template or run automated facial recognition or age estimation. A human reviewer compares the images by eye. Counsel is asked whether this is still biometric data for legal purposes (Question 1).

5 Processors and international transfers

Provider	Role in this feature	Region
Railway	Hosts the application and the Postgres database that holds the encrypted evidence and request records	UNKNOWN (to be confirmed from the account)
LiveKit	Carries the live video call (cloud service or self-hosted: UNKNOWN)	UNKNOWN
Resend	Sends decision and invite emails (contain no evidence)	UNKNOWN

We do not yet have data processing agreements on file for these providers. Whether a transfer mechanism is needed for Nigerian or UK users depends on the hosting regions, which we will confirm.

6 Lawful basis and consent

We intend to ask for explicit consent through the pop-up before any capture. The user can refuse and keep using the app, but then cannot use the adult-only features. The pop-up states who sees the data, what is kept, when it is deleted and what the user can choose (Appendix A). The wording is our draft and has not been reviewed.

We have not decided whether consent is the right basis. Alternatives include legal obligation (if the law requires age assurance for these features) and legitimate interests (protecting minors and preventing underage use of money features). Counsel is asked to advise, including whether a consent that is a condition of access to a feature is freely given.

7 Children

The minimum age to register is 13, from a self-typed date of birth. There is no parental consent step. Users aged 13 to 17 face restrictions: adult and under-18 direct messages are blocked unless both people opt in and a warning is shown; rooms hosted by an under-18 are 'minors' rooms' that adults can only enter by a personal host invitation they acknowledge; paid tickets and tipping require a verified adult.

The age review is not offered to users who registered as under 18. A user who registered as under 18 but is an adult uses the existing birthdate-correction route through support, which is audited and requires a reason.

If a document shows that an account registered as an adult belongs to a minor, the account is moved to the teen age group. The submitted images of that minor are handled like any other evidence and deleted at once. Counsel is asked about any reporting or record-keeping duties in that situation (Question 5).

8 Retention and deletion

Item	Retention
Evidence images	Deleted in the same database transaction as the final decision, cancel or expiry. Exceptions: when a reviewer asks for another photo, or a birthdate change waits for a second approval, the images are kept until that is decided (at most 7 days from the request). A user can cancel in every open state, which deletes the images. The hourly sweep and a sweep at start-up run even if the feature is switched off, so switching it off cannot strand old photos. A health check raises an alert if any evidence outlives its request.
Request record (no images)	Kept for as long as the account exists. Account deletion (a soft delete, see Section 10) already purges the user's age review request records. Consequence: the stored fingerprint disappears with the record, so a document used on a deleted account could later verify a new account. Counsel to advise whether that trade-off is acceptable (Question 6).
Fingerprint (document number hash)	Kept with the request record and removed with it. Counsel to advise on necessity and period.
Admin audit log	Append-only. Retention period not yet set.
Backups	UNKNOWN (provider setting). Evidence deletion in the live database will not reach backups made before deletion.

Emergency controls: a super-administrator can delete all stored evidence immediately, and can pause new submissions at once.

9 Security and safeguards

- Evidence encrypted at rest in the database with an application-held key; decryption failure refuses to return anything.
- Evidence is stored apart from ordinary uploaded images (which are readable by link). It has no public address.
- Reveal tokens, headers that prevent caching, on-screen watermark, re-blur, rate limit and audit log (Section 3).
- Error messages and server logs never carry evidence, and a code check fails the build if evidence is passed to a logger.
- No image reaches any third party. The video provider carries live calls only.
- Duplicate-document check using the keyed hash, and a revoke-verification action for later suspicion.
- Server refuses to start in production with the feature on and the encryption key missing.

10 Existing platform facts counsel should know

The following were found in a review of the current code on 25 October 2026. They concern the wider platform, not only the age review. We list them so that counsel sees the whole picture and can advise on fixing or disclosing each. Not every route was read line by line, and production settings were not inspected.

Area	What the code shows
Privacy policy	No privacy policy page exists. The footer labels 'Privacy', 'Terms' and 'Contact' on the landing page are plain text, not links. A privacy policy page is part of this build. There is no terms-of-service acceptance at sign-up, and the only terms file is an eight-line Safety Buddy document.
Consent and cookies	No cookie banner and no consent controls. No analytics, advertising or tracking scripts were found in the client. The browser does contact Google Fonts, map tile services and, in rooms, embedded players, which can reveal the visitor's IP address.
Account deletion	Deletion is a soft delete. It removes profile details, date of birth, location rows, phone, devices and some social-event data, and ends the session. It does not remove posts, comments, direct messages, uploaded media, notifications, push subscriptions, safety buddy contacts and alerts, or the saved-card record. Money records are kept by design.
Data export	There is no download-my-data feature.
Uploaded images and videos	Stored inside the database and served by an unguessable link without any login check, with public caching for one hour. Anyone holding a link can view the file.
Password reset tokens	Stored unhashed in the database (valid one hour). Email verification tokens are hashed.
Safety alerts	Alerts with coordinates, public share links and delivery logs with buddy phone numbers have no deletion job. Retention appears indefinite.
Server logs	Include email addresses and IP addresses for login and email events, and the first characters of JSON responses. Log retention is UNKNOWN.
Sign-up and age	Minimum age 13 from a self-typed date. The sign-up API does not itself force a date of birth (the form may). No parental consent flow.
Staff access control	Two-factor login for administrators is enforced only for super-administrators and only when an environment setting is on (production value UNKNOWN).
Other processors in use	Paystack and Stripe (payments), Twilio and Termii (SMS, including emergency alerts with coordinates), LiveKit (video), Zernio (social posting), Google sign-in, Sentry (server errors, if configured), push notification services. Data processing agreements and regions UNKNOWN.

11 Questions for counsel

1. Is a selfie compared by a human with a document photo, with no template or automated matching, 'biometric' or 'sensitive' data under the Nigeria Data Protection Act 2023 and under UK GDPR? Does the answer change the lawful basis?
2. Which lawful basis should we rely on (consent, legal obligation, legitimate interests)? Is consent valid when it is the price of access to adult features? Is the proposed pop-up sufficient?
3. Is a data protection impact assessment required? Which registrations or filings apply in Nigeria (including any 'data controller of major importance' registration) and in the UK?
4. Children: is a minimum age of 13 and no parental consent step acceptable in Nigeria (where a child is under 18) and in the UK? Does the age review change anything for the 13 to 17 group?
5. If a document reveals that an account holder is a minor, what must or may we do with that information, and are there reporting duties?
6. Retention: is deleting images at decision (maximum 7 days) enough? How long may we keep the request record and the document fingerprint, and must they be deleted when an account is soft-deleted?
7. Transfers: once hosting regions are known, what mechanisms are needed for data of Nigerian and UK users? Which data processing agreements must we have?

8. Staff: what confidentiality terms, training and logging should reviewers be under? Is our access design (roles, reveal tokens, audit, two-factor) adequate?
9. Live video check: any obligations about informing the user, recording laws, or consent to a video call with staff?
10. UK Online Safety Act and any Nigerian online safety or platform duties: does Vib3Pulse need 'highly effective' age assurance, and would manual review by a person comparing a photo ID qualify?
11. Data subject rights process: access, correction of date of birth, erasure, objection, withdrawing consent, complaints. Do we need a data protection officer? What response times apply?
12. Breach handling: what notice must go to the regulator and to users, and within what period?
13. Please review the privacy policy page text and the pop-up text, and tell us what terms of service we should adopt.
14. Money: separately from age, what know-your-customer or anti-money-laundering duties apply to hosts who receive tips and payouts, and does this feature help or hinder them?
15. For each item in Section 10, should we remediate before launch, disclose in the privacy policy, or both?

Appendix A Privacy pop-up text (draft)

Shown before any upload or call. The user must tick 'I understand how my information is used' and press Continue. 'Not now' closes it and stores nothing. The wording below is the product team's draft and is not reviewed.

Part	Text
Title	Before you verify your age
Why we ask	Tipping, buying tickets and hosting paid rooms are for adults only. We check once. You can use the rest of Vib3Pulse without it.
Who sees it (upload)	Only Vib3Pulse staff who review ages (administrators, super administrators and age reviewers). Your images are encrypted in our database and are opened one at a time, with every viewing logged.
Who sees it (live check)	A reviewer sees you on a private call. Nothing is recorded or saved.
What happens (upload)	A reviewer compares your document with the birthdate you gave when you signed up. We delete your photos after the final decision, or after 7 days from when you started, whichever comes first. If a second approval is needed, they are kept until that is decided, within the 7 days.
What happens (live check)	A reviewer compares your document with the birthdate you gave when you signed up. Nothing is recorded or saved.
What we keep	We keep a record of the decision: who made it, when, the type of document, whether the birthdate matched, and the reason if it was declined. A reviewer may also write a short note about the decision (up to 300 characters), which is kept in our staff audit log. We also keep the birthdate you registered with at the time, and a one-way code made from your document number. The code cannot be turned back into the number without our secret key, and it only stops the same document being used on several accounts. We do not keep your photos or the document number itself. Notifications and emails about the result do not contain your documents.
Your choices	Cover everything except your photo, name and date of birth. Cancel any time before a decision and your photos are deleted. Choose the live check instead of uploading. Saying no only means the adult only features stay off. (Cancel is allowed in every open state, including while a second approval is pending.)
Your safety	If your document shows you are under 18, we will move your account to the right age group.
Links	Read the full privacy policy. Ask about your data (info@aeoluslabsltd.com).

Appendix B Reviewer decision and access summary

Action	Who may do it	Safeguard
Reveal evidence	super_admin, admin, age_reviewer	Single-use 60 second token, watermark, re-blur at 30 seconds, 60 per hour, audit row
Verify	super_admin, admin, age_reviewer	Checklist, document number typed for hash only, cannot review own request
Teen correction	Same	Uses the existing audited birthdate-correction route, clears verification, notifies the user
Birthdate change	First reviewer, then a different super_admin	Nothing changes until the second approval
Direct mark-verified (emergency)	super_admin, admin, age_reviewer	Reason required, audited. Removed from user_support.
Revoke verification	super_admin, admin, age_reviewer	Reason required, audited
Pause intake	super_admin or admin to pause, super_admin to resume	Stops new submissions at once
Emergency purge of all evidence	super_admin	Reason required, audited

Appendix C Data flow (text)

1. User's browser re-encodes the images and sends them over HTTPS to the Vib3Pulse server.
2. The server checks the file type, encrypts each image and stores it in the Railway Postgres database with the request.
3. A reviewer opens the request. Evidence is fetched only after Reveal, decrypted in memory and streamed to that reviewer's browser.
4. The reviewer submits a decision. In one transaction the server updates the request, applies any account change, and deletes the encrypted images.
5. The user receives an in-app notification and an email with the result. Neither contains evidence.
6. Live route: both parties connect their browsers to the video provider for a call of at most 20 minutes. No recording is made.

Appendix D Public privacy policy page

A public page at /privacy is built (marked 'Draft, under legal review' until counsel approves), with contact info@aeoluslabsltd.com. The age review section and every sentence about the age review are hidden from the public page until the feature is switched on. Its sections: what we collect and why; who sees it; how long we keep it; who processes it for us; where it is stored; children and age groups; the age review; your rights and how to use them; security; changes to the policy; contact. The text is held in a single file so counsel can edit it without changing code. The first version will state only facts verified against the code, including the gaps in Section 10 where relevant. It will be published only after counsel has reviewed it.